

MELISSA SMITH

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Senior QA/Testing professional, 9 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: pytest, Postman, Docker.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

IBM — QA Analyst

November 2022 to Current | Lake Jody (Remote (UK))

- Drove accessibility coverage from 8% to 96% of core journeys.
- Built a performance harness in pytest simulating 40k concurrent users.
- Owned release sign-off for 5 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 30% to 96%.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in pytest, catching defects staging had missed.

Test Automation Engineer, Amber Creek Software

September 2019 to July 2022 | Elizabethstad

- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 2 hours to 4 minutes through parallelisation.
- Mentored 10 manual testers into automation roles.
- Automated 6 regression suites with pytest, cutting the manual test cycle by 35%.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.

Junior Test Automation Engineer, IBM

October 2016 to May 2019 | East Dana (Hybrid - 2 days on-site)

- Established test data management practices later adopted by 6 teams.
- Reduced escaped defects by 22% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Bachelor, Computer Science

West Traceyborough Institute of Technology | 2013 to 2016

SKILLS & TOOLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Scala

Cloud & DevOps: Docker

Data: Snowflake, PostgreSQL

Testing & Tooling: pytest, Postman, Jira, Git

Certifications

Professional Data Engineer — Google Cloud, 2019

Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft, 2022

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — Cloud Native Computing Foundation, 2017

Recognition

Dean's List, 2026